

Lincolnshire Knee Clinic

Consultant-Led Specialist Knee Care

ACL Rehabilitation Protocols (Phase 1)

Physiotherapy protocols for early ACL graft protection

Rehabilitation Objectives

Early physiotherapy focuses on swelling control, achieving full extension, and reactivating the quadriceps muscle.

1. Quadriceps Sets (Static Quads)

- Technique: Lie flat, push the back of your knee down into the bed to tighten your thigh. Hold for 5 seconds.
- Frequency: 10 repetitions, 4-6 times daily.

2. Heel Slides

- Technique: Gently slide your heel toward your buttocks, bending your knee as far as comfortable. Hold for 5 seconds.
- Frequency: 3 sets of 10 repetitions, twice daily.

3. Patellar Mobilisation

- Technique: Use your fingers to gently push your kneecap up, down, and side to side.
- Frequency: 2-3 minutes, twice daily to prevent scar tissue formation.